

Breathing Exercise Guide

Three simple breathing techniques to reduce physical tension and anxiety — diaphragmatic breathing, 4-7-8 breathing, and box breathing.

Diaphragmatic (belly) breathing

- Sit or lie down comfortably, one hand on your chest, one on your belly
- Breathe in slowly through your nose, letting your belly rise (chest stays relatively still)
- Breathe out slowly through your mouth, letting your belly fall
- Repeat for 5-10 breaths, focusing on the slow, steady rhythm

4-7-8 breathing

- Breathe in quietly through your nose for a count of 4
- Hold your breath for a count of 7
- Exhale completely through your mouth for a count of 8
- Repeat for up to 4 cycles; this technique can feel intense at first, so start gently

Box breathing

- Breathe in for a count of 4
- Hold for a count of 4
- Breathe out for a count of 4
- Hold empty for a count of 4, then repeat the cycle

Tips for practice

Practice these techniques daily when calm, not just during moments of high anxiety — this builds the skill so it's easier to use effectively when you need it most.

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This material is for patient and family education only and does not replace individualized medical advice. For a personal diagnosis or treatment plan, consult Dr. Kushal Kharel or a qualified mental health professional.

Dr. Kushal Kharel, MD Psychiatry — Consultant Psychiatrist, Kathmandu, Nepal

Phone: +977 9861800547 · drkushalkharel@gmail.com · drkushalkharel.com.np

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